Using annotated assessment exemplars

Do students see annotated examples of good work?

LANGUAGE / ASSESSMENT

ONE-PAGE TEACHING GUIDE

WHAT IS IT?

Annotated exemplars, supported by activities that unpack them, model assessment expectations

WHY DOES IT MATTER?

University contains many hidden rules: what “critical analysis” means, what a rubric is really asking for, when it is acceptable to ask for help, or what counts as “professional” behaviour. If those rules remain unspoken, familiarity can be mistaken for capability.

THE STUDENT EXPERIENCE

- “Everyone else seems to know rules nobody has explained.”
- “I understand the topic, but not what I am being asked to do.”

HOW CAN I DO IT?

- Provide more than a finished sample by annotating what makes it effective.
- Ask students to analyse exemplars against criteria.
- Use the activity to surface common misunderstandings before submission.

EXAMPLE IN PRACTICE

Students compare two sample responses, annotate them against the rubric and discuss why one more clearly meets the standard.

STARTING POINT TO ADAPT

For this assessment, we aim to show annotated examples that make the qualities of successful work visible. The learning outcomes being assessed are [insert outcomes].

GO FURTHER AT UQ

View the Influential Communicators example

Creating and using rubrics

Feedback for learning